There were a hundred and fifty-four French, thirty-four Dutch, and a hundred and thirty-three Americans; of these, twelve French, twenty-five Dutch, and nine Americans were in the hospital. The wards were not clean.[1] No regulations hung up. I weighed several of the six-pound loaves, and they all wanted some ounces of weight.

The American prisoners then had an allowance from the States, paid by order of Dr. Franklin. I found a gentleman of Portsmouth distributing this kind allowance. From Lady Day to Michaelmas, officers received one shilling per week, and seamen sixpence: and from Michaelmas to Lady Day, officers two shillings and seamen one shilling per week. American officers were not on parole as other officers.

Received into this prison,

13 June, 1777,	to 6 Nov.,	1782,	American	1,200	Died	69
30 June, 1778	„ 6 Nov.,	1782,	French	11,720	„	166
11 June, 1779	„ 3 July,	1782,	Spanish	3,028	„	167
30 Dec., 1780	„ 28 Sept.,	1782,	Dutch	934	„	17
			Total	16,882		419

PEMBROKE. On the 5th and 6th of June, 1779, I visited the prisons at Pembroke. There were fifty-six French prisoners in an old house adjoining to that in which the Americans were confined. Most of them had no shoes or stockings, and some were also without shirts. They had no victualling table, nor did they know what was their allowance. There were two or three who had their allowance in money, which should have been three shillings and sixpence a week each for their aliment, but sixpence was deducted. They lay, in general, on the boards without straw; for there were but four hammocks. in two rooms, each of which contained eighteen prisoners. Here was a courtyard, but no water or sewer.

Such observations as these have convinced me, that humanity and good policy require that inspectors of the prisoners of war should be appointed, who should be desired to report quarterly their state as to health, provisions, etc. No doubt some independent gentlemen in the neighbourhood would accept such a humane office without a salary.

In another view, also, such an appointment would be advantageous. These prisons are usually guarded by the militia, and the sentinels have in several instances shown themselves too ready to fire on the prisoners, in which they have been countenanced by inexperienced officers. Several persons have thus been killed on the spot, though perhaps there was no serious design of an escape. The agent is too much in awe of the officers to make inquiries and representations on these occasions; whereas an independent gentleman would probably exert himself in a proper manner.

[1] It might have been better, if in the rooms appropriated to the sick there had been women nurses, as in the Royal Hospitals at Haslar and Plymouth, which are neat and clean.

AMERICAN PRISONERS

PLYMOUTH. In Mill Prison near Plymouth, there were two hundred and ninety-eight American prisoners on 3 February, 1779. Their wards and court were spacious and convenient, and their bread, beer, and meat good. On 30 July, 1782, there were only seven American prisoners.

FORTON. The Americans were equally well accommodated at Forton near Gosport, where I found two hundred and fifty-one prisoners, 2 March, 1779.

The table of regulations was almost the same with that for the French prisoners. The principal difference was, that in the victualling table, the bread allowance was then only one pound a day. The meagre day was Saturday; and against the weekly article of two pints of peas, was added, "or greens in lieu." The regulation, Art. 5, is well worth copying. "As water and tubs for washing their linen and clothes, will be allowed, the prisoners are advised to keep their persons as clean as possible, it being very conducive to health."

PEMBROKE. At Pembroke, 5 June, 1779, there were confined in an old house thirty-seven American prisoners. Some of them were without shoes and stockings. There was no victualling table, or table of regulations; nor did they know what was the allowance ordered by Government. They lay on straw on the floor, and their straw had not been changed for six or seven weeks. By liberal subscriptions, ample provision had been made for the other American prisoners: I was sorry to find that these had been entirely overlooked.

In a house appropriated for a hospital, in which were some English sailors and French prisoners, I found also three American